```
<div data-controller="thing">
  <div data-controller="thing">
  </div>
</div>
```

This works just fine—anything declared as part of a thing controller is connected to its nearest matching ancestor in the DOM tree.

Also important to keep in mind is that a single element can be attached to multiple controllers, separated by spaces:

```
<div data-controller="color size shape">
</div>
```

This element instantiates three different controllers: ColorController, SizeController, and ShapeController (assuming the controllers have actually been defined in app/javascript/controllers). Inside the element, targets and actions can be directed at any of the controllers.

Finally, you can access the DOM element that the controller is actually attached to with this.element anywhere inside the controller.

These features make Stimulus great for small, generic, composable controllers.

Controllers are great, but they don’t do much on their own; they need to be attached to actions.